

THE ALPHABET, HAND TO HAND

Rows run in the transmission order (the shared abgad sequence + Greek post-tau additions), so each column reads top-to-bottom in its own alphabet's order. Classical Latin shows the alphabet at the turn of the millennium: the original slot-7 Z is gone (dropped ~3rd c. BCE), G holds that seat, and re-imported Y and Z sit at the end. Later Latin gives the modern letter with its main sound-developments across Europe (Romance + English). Greek-only letters (Θ Ξ Μ Φ Ψ Ω) drop into their Greek positions; faded cells mark ancestors or re-imports that don't count for the ordering.

/a/ sound changed /a/ held ̣ faded = doesn't count for order ̸ Greek-only, no Latin heir

SOURCE WORD PROTO-SINAITIC · HEBREW · ~1800 BCE	PHOENICIAN ~1050 BCE	GREEK ~800 BCE	ETRUSCAN ~700 BCE	CLASSICAL LATIN ~ AD 1	LATER LATIN MODERN LETTER · SOUND IN EUROPE	SHIFTS & NOTES	MODERN GREEK TODAY · VS ANCIENT
ʕalp · ox 𐤀𐤋 elef thousand	𐤀 /ʔ/	Α /a/	𐤁 /a/	Α /a/	Α Eng. name /eɪ/ (GVS)	Consonant → vowel: Greek reheard the glottal stop as /a/. (Ox sense survives in <i>aluf</i> , ‘chief’.)	Α α /a/ álfa
bayt · house בַּיִת bayit house	𐤁 /b/	Β /b/	𐤅 — unused	Β /b/	Β W. Rom. b→v/; Sp. b=v	Etruscan carried B in its abecedarium but never used it (no /b/); Latin reactivated it.	Β β /v/ víta
gaml · camel גָּמַל gamal camel	𐤂 /g/	Γ /g/	𐤆 /k/	ϸ /k/	ϸ palat.: It./tʃ/·Fr./s/·Sp./θ/	Voicing lost at Etruscan (/g/→/k/); early C also spelled /g/ — that job passed to G.	Γ γ /ɣ/ gámma
dalt · door דָּלַת delet door	𐤃 /d/	Δ /d/	𐤄 — unused	Δ /d/	Δ Sp. intervoc. →[ð]	Carried but unused in Etruscan (no /d/); reactivated in Latin.	Δ δ /ð/ délta
— uncertain הָ he name only	𐤄 /h/	Ε /e/	𐤅 /e/	Ε /e/	Ε Eng.→/i:/ (GVS)	Consonant → vowel at Greek (/h/ → /e/). The name <i>he</i> is no living noun; its picture is unknown.	Ε ε /e/ épsilon
waw · hook וַ vav hook	𐤅 /w/	Ϝ /w/	𐤆 /w/	Ϝ /ɸ/	Ϝ Sp. f→h- (hijo)	Digamma kept waw's /w/; Etruscan wrote /f/ as ϜϚ. Latin reassigned the shape to /f/ once V (← upsilon) took /w/.	— digamma dropped · numeral Ϛ = 6
zayin · weapon זַיִן zayin weapon	𐤆 /z/	Ζ /zd/	𐤇 /ts/	— dropped ~312 BCE	—	Latin's two Z's : at slot 7 in the Phoenician–Greek order. Dropped from Latin ~3rd c. BCE (rhotacism /z/→/r/); G took its seat; re-imported to the end 1st c. BCE (row below).	Ζ ζ /z/ zíta
gaml · camel גָּמַל gamal (via C)	𐤂 /g/	Γ /g/	𐤆 /k/	ϸ /g/	ϸ palat.: It./dʒ/·Fr./ʒ/·Sp./x/	New sign, c. 230 BCE : a bar added to C to restore the /g/ Etruscan had erased — into the 7th seat Z vacated.	Γ γ /ɣ/ gámma
ḥet · fence? חֵת het name only	𐤇 /h/	Η /h/ · /ɛ:/	𐤈 /h/	Η /h/	Η silent across Romance	Phoenician ḥet merges /h+/χ/. Greek forks : Western heta /h/ vs Ionic eta /ɛ:/; Latin took the Western /h/ branch.	Η η /i/ íta
ṭet · wheel? ט tet name only	𐤈 /tˤ/	Θ /tʰ/	𐤉 /tʰ/	— → TH	—	Phoenician emphatic ṭet → Greek aspirate theta /tʰ/. Latin had no letter and wrote Greek θ as the digraph TH . Modern Greek fricativized it to /θ/.	Θ θ /θ/ thíta
yad · hand יָ yad hand	𐤊 /j/	Ι /i/	𐤍 /i/	Ι /i/	Ι Eng.→/aɪ/ (GVS); cons.→J	Consonant → vowel at Greek (/j/ → /i/); Latin used it for both /i/ and /j/ — the /j/ half later split off as J.	Ι ι /i/ ióta
yad · hand יָ yad (via I)	—	—	—	— = I	Ј /dʒ/·/ʒ/·/x/·/j/	Youngest letter : a 16th-c. swash split from I to carry the consonant /j/ → /dʒ/. Absent at 0 AD.	Ι ι /i/ ióta
kap · palm כַּפּ kaf palm	𐤋 /k/	Κ /k/	𐤌 /k/	Κ /k/	Κ stable /k/	Etruscan used K before /a/ — part of a three-way C / K / Q split by following vowel that Latin inherited.	Κ κ /k/ káppa
lamd · goad לָמַד lamed ‘to learn’	𐤍 /l/	Λ /l/	𐤎 /l/	Λ /l/	Λ Sp. -ll→/ʎ/→/j/	<i>Stable throughout.</i>	Λ λ /l/ lámda
maym · water מַיִם mayim water	𐤎 /m/	Μ /m/	𐤏 /m/	Μ /m/	Μ stable	<i>Stable throughout.</i>	Μ μ /m/ mí
nun · fish נִן nun fish = dag	𐤏 /n/	Ν /n/	𐤐 /n/	Ν /n/	Ν -gn→/ɲ/ (ñ)	<i>Stable throughout.</i> (‘Fish’ is the Aramaic sense; Hebrew for fish is <i>dag</i> .)	Ν ν /n/ nī

SOURCE WORD PROTO-SINAITIC · HEBREW · ~1800 BCE	PHOENICIAN ~1050 BCE	GREEK ~800 BCE	ETRUSCAN ~700 BCE	CLASSICAL LATIN ~ AD 1	LATER LATIN MODERN LETTER · SOUND IN EUROPE	SHIFTS & NOTES	MODERN GREEK TODAY · VS ANCIENT
samek · prop 𐤌 samekh <i>support</i>	𐤌 /s/	Ξ <i>/ks/</i>	—	— → X	—	Samekh took the 14th slot, repurposed by Greek for /ks/. Latin got /ks/ from Western <i>chi</i> → <i>X</i> , so xi itself left no Latin heir.	Ξ ξ /ks/ ksi
ʿayn · eye 𐤀 ayin eye	𐤀 /ʿ/	Ο <i>/o/</i>	𐤀 — unused	Ο /o/	Ο Eng.→/oo/ (GVS)	Phoenician ayin merges /ʿ/ + /g/. Consonant → vowel at Greek. Etruscan had no /o/ (unused); Latin reactivated it.	Ο ο /o/ ómicron
pe · mouth 𐤐 pe mouth	𐤐 /p/	Π /p/	𐤐 /p/	P /p/	P W. Rom. p→b→v	<i>Stable throughout.</i>	Π π /p/ pi
šade · fish-hook? 𐤑 tsade <i>name only</i>	𐤑 /sʕ/	Μ <i>/s/</i>	—	— → S	—	Phoenician emphatic <i>šade</i> → Greek <i>san</i> (Μ). Sigma won; san died before the classical age. No Latin heir — /s/ reached Latin via sigma → S. Afterlife: numeral 𐤑 (sampi, 900), debated.	— obsolete · sampi 𐤑 = 900?
— uncertain 𐤒 qof monkey (mod.)	𐤒 /q/	Ϟ <i>/k/</i>	𐤒 /k/	Q /k/	Q /kw/→/k/ (que)	Qoppa, before back vowels; dropped from classical Greek (numeral 90). Latin keeps Q only in QV.	— koppa dropped · numeral 𐤒 = 90
raʿš · head 𐤓 rosh <i>head</i>	𐤓 /ɾ/	P /ɾ/	𐤓 /ɾ/	R /ɾ/	R Fr.→ uvular /ʁ/	Sound stable; Latin added the diagonal leg to tell R apart from P.	P ρ /ɾ/ ro
šin · tooth 𐤔 shen <i>tooth</i>	𐤔 /ʃ/	Ξ <i>/s/</i>	𐤔 /s/	S /s/	S Fr. drops pre-cons.; Sp. e-	Sibilant shuffle: shin's /ʃ/ became sigma's /s/ (and swapped names with samek).	Σ σ/ς /s/ sigma
taw · mark 𐤕 tav <i>mark, sign</i>	𐤕 /t/	T /t/	𐤕 /t/	T /t/	T -ti-→/ts/→/s/ (nation)	<i>Stable throughout.</i>	T τ /t/ taf
waw · hook 𐤖 vav (via Y)	𐤖 /w/	Υ <i>/u/</i>	V /u/	— = V	U Eng.→/ju:/	Upsilon — waw's second child, appended at the Greek alphabet's end as vowel /u/. U split from V in the late Middle Ages. Absent at 0 AD.	Υ υ /i/ ipsilon
waw · hook 𐤖 vav (via Y)	𐤖 /w/	Υ <i>/u/</i>	V /u, w/	V /w, u/	V Lat./w/→/v/; Sp. v=b	Same upsilon line; in Latin, V served both /w/ and /u/. The whole U · V · W · Y clan descends from this one sign.	Υ υ /i/ ipsilon
waw · hook 𐤖 vav (via V)	—	—	—	— = V	W Eng./w/ · Ger./v/	Doubled V — a medieval invention for a Germanic /w/ that Latin had no letter for. Absent at 0 AD.	Υ υ /i/ ipsilon
— <i>Greek invention</i>	—	Φ /pʰ/	𐤕 /pʰ/	— → PH	—	A Greek invention (with Ψ, X) for aspirated /pʰ/ — no Phoenician parent. Latin wrote it PH ; Modern Greek turned it into /f/.	Φ φ <i>/ɸ/</i> fi
samek · prop 𐤕𐤑 samekh (via X)	—	X /ks/	X /ks/	X /ks/	X Sp.→/x/~/s/ (México)	A Greek supplemental with no Phoenician parent. Latin took the Western value /ks/; Eastern Greek used X for /kʰ/. Ends the classical alphabet before Y, Z.	X χ <i>/x/</i> chi · /ks/ = Ξ
waw · hook 𐤖 vav (via Y)	𐤖 /w/	Υ <i>/y/</i>	—	Y /y/	Y Gk /y/ (ü) → /i/	Re-borrowed straight from Greek upsilon in the 1st c. BCE for Greek loanwords — bypassing Etruscan; the ‘Greek i’. (Upsilon faded — already solid at U/V.)	Υ υ /i/ ipsilon
— <i>Greek invention</i>	—	Ψ /ps/	—	— → PS	—	A Greek invention for /ps/ (Eastern value; Western Greek used the shape for /kʰ/). No Latin letter — written PS . Stable today.	Ψ ψ /ps/ psi
— <i>Ionian, ʿO</i>	—	Ω /ɔ:/	—	— → 0	—	The last Greek letter — an Ionian addition (~7th–6th c. BCE), a long-/ɔ:/ twin of omicron. Latin used O . Modern Greek merged it back to plain /o/.	Ω ω <i>/o/</i> oméga
ʿ zayin (row 7)	—	Z /z/	—	Z /z/	Z It./ts/ · Sp./θ/ (zapato)	Latin's re-import of Z (1st c. BCE) sits at the alphabet's end — its ancestral 7th seat had gone to G. Its Phoenician–Greek ancestry is in the slot-7 row above.	—

On the **glyphs**. Unicode's canonical reference forms, not the variable shapes actually inscribed; Etruscan ran right-to-left, and Classical Latin had no lowercase (I and V each did double duty until J, U, W split off in the Middle Ages). The Later-Latin column is a headline sketch — Romance outcomes vary by language and position. Source words and several values are reconstructed and debated (E, H, Q, 𐤑et, šade). Digamma (F), koppa (Q) and san (M) survive in Greek only as numerals or not at all.